

Guest brief — Varun Mayya

Researched 2026-08-03 · Version **V1** · Research score **7/10** New channel · Language: Hinglish · Angle: not yet chosen — three candidates at the end.

Collection summary

Source	Window	Items	Status
YouTube search (2 queries)	all-time	80 → 61 relevant	ok
His own channel, newest	May 2025 – Jul 2026	40	ok
Full transcripts	—	10 (129,384 words)	ok
Instagram	30 d	0 — blocked twice, 2 actors	FAILED
X / Twitter	60 d	not attempted	skipped by design
YouTube comments	—	not attempted	skipped by design

Cost: \$0.47 — YouTube search \$0.316 · channel pull \$0.156 · Instagram attempts \$0.003 · **all 10 transcripts \$0.00.**

Skips were deliberate, carried over from the Ritesh run: X and LinkedIn return placeholder items on Apify's free tier, and comments were the worst return per rupee. Instagram genuinely failed here — `apify/instagram-post-scraper` and `apify/instagram-scraper` both returned "Request got blocked". It matters less for this guest than it would for most: 41 of 61 relevant videos are on his own channel, so YouTube is where he actually publishes his thinking.

Transcripts analyzed:

Appearance	Date	Length	Words
WTF is ChatGPT (Nikhil Kamath, Ep #4)	2023-05-14	2:28:40	26,965
Mundhe Banni Podcast	2026-02-07	2:04:20	22,677
Bad Decisions Studio	2024-10-29	1:23:50	18,729
Guide to Scaling A Startup with Zero Funding (KATA 1)	2025-12-21	1:18:41	15,572
10 Projects I've Built	2026-06-27	0:43:03	10,036
Best Skill to Learn in 2026	2026-02-17	0:41:06	8,325
How Distribution Can 10x Your Luck (KATA 10)	2026-07-16	0:39:23	7,217
5 Apps I Built With AI to Run My 500-Person Company	2026-07-06	0:30:10	7,099
Reacting To Your Feedback On Unleash The Avatar	2026-06-30	0:31:32	6,802
How Simplifying Everything Makes You Rich	2026-07-26	0:28:50	5,962

1. The central tension ★ — read this first

His channel teaches AI leverage: automate everything, five apps replace a team, agents do the work. The reality underneath it is the opposite shape.

"We have **500 employees** now and we absolutely need a CFO." — Best Skill to Learn in 2026, 2026-02-17 [32:00] [V]

"We are now sitting at close to **500 employees**. Last month we did **a billion views** across all our channels, ourselves and our customers." — Mundhe Banni Podcast, 2026-02-07 [53:26] [V]

"Yes, we're working on a Souls-like, technically a Sekiro-like. **It's a 40-man team.**" — 10 Projects I've Built, 2026-06-27 [31:14] [V]

The man best known in India for "AI can run your company" is running a **500-person headcount business**, hiring an expensive CFO, and staffing a **40-person** game studio.

That is not hypocrisy and shouldn't be framed as a gotcha — it is the most interesting unexplained thing about him, and **the count appears only 3 times across 129,384 words**. Nobody has asked him to reconcile it. This is the episode.

2. Core themes (by transcript frequency)

Theme	Mentions across 10 appearances
Automation / agents / n8n	67
Prompting, how to actually use AI	47
Scenes (his product)	33
Dropping out / college	26
Avalon Labs origin	18
Unleash The Avatar (game)	13 — all since Jun 2026
KATA framework series	5
500-person company	3 ⚠️
India vs Silicon Valley	3

The gap between row 1 and the second-to-last row is the whole opportunity.

3. Signature frameworks

Framework	What it is	Freshness
KATA series	numbered lesson series (KATA 1–10+), his flagship teaching format — scaling with zero funding, risk-taking, distribution, hiring	circulating — it is his own catalogue, so recapping it adds nothing
Automate-anything / n8n workflows	agent-and-workflow tutorials	commodity — 67 mentions; the single most saturated thing he does
Prompting discipline ("99% of you prompt AI wrong")	how to actually instruct models	commodity
Distribution as luck multiplier	KATA 10, 2026-07-16	circulating
Kora — custom C++ combat system for the game	built from scratch, with an internal AI documentation interface so new C++ engineers can query it	fresh ★ — barely explained anywhere
EOS / AOS Labs	his system for bringing young builders in; commercialized, incl. work with Bangalore police	fresh ★

4. Unfinished threads ★

Note on method: the usual verbal seams ("long story short", "that's another video") returned **zero hits**. His own-channel content is scripted and produced, so it does not leave conversational loose ends. Everything

below comes from things stated once and dropped, not from hedges.

#	Thread	Quote	Where
1	The 500 people	"We have 500 employees now and we absolutely need a CFO"	bestskill2026 [32:00]
2	A billion views in one month	"Last month we did a billion views across all our channels, ourselves and our customers"	mundhebanni [53:26]
3	The game he wanted to build since 2008	"remember that game project from 2008? That thing that I always wanted to do from 2007, 2008? Now it's a mature version of [him] trying it"	10projects [31:14]
4	Viral in China	"it's gone super viral in China" — an Indian Souls-like finding a Chinese audience	10projects [31:14]
5	The legacy line ★	"EOS is the thing that hopefully I will be known for after I pass away"	10projects [40:56]
6	Kora + AI documentation	"we have our own combat system built from scratch, called Kora... new C++ engineers can ask any query in real time"	5apps [20:49]
7	The Scenes pivot	rooms of 200–500 people, Tanmay Bhat once drew ~1,000, "but we didn't make any money. Ultimately I had to take this hard call to pivot to B2B to survive"	10projects [05:57]

Thread 5 is the strongest single question in this brief. A 30-something founder naming what he wants to be remembered for, in passing, in a listicle video, is an entire segment nobody has opened.

5. Kill list — do not ask

Beat	Why it's dead
"How should people use AI / prompting basics"	47 mentions; his channel <i>is</i> this
"Which AI tools do you use", n8n workflows, automation tutorials	67 mentions; the most saturated topic he has
"Will AI take our jobs"	already done at scale on Nikhil Kamath's <i>WTF is ChatGPT</i> (1.17M views, 2:28:40) and its dedicated clip " <i>Jobs AI Will Replace In India</i> " (160k)
College dropout story	26 mentions
Avalon Labs founding story	18 mentions
Anything from KATA 1–10	it is his own published catalogue — a viewer can watch it free

Competitive note. His long-form is already owned: Nikhil Kamath (1.17M), Bad Decisions Studio (198k), Mundhe Banni (2h04m, Feb 2026). A new channel repeating "AI + automation with Varun Mayya" is competing directly against those and against **his own channel**, which publishes better-produced versions of the same material every week.

6. Recent delta (Jun–Jul 2026)

- **Unleash The Avatar** — Bollywood Souls-like, gameplay trailer 2026-06-23 (228k views), 40-person team, viral in China, custom engine work [V]
- **"Reacting To Your Feedback On Unleash The Avatar"** (2026-06-30) — he is now running a public feedback loop on a game, a very different posture from tutorial content [V]
- **"5 Apps I Built With AI to Run My 500-Person Company"** (2026-07-06) [V]
- **"10 Projects I've Built and 1 Thing I Learned From Each"** (2026-06-27) [V]
- **"How Simplifying Everything Makes You Rich"** (2026-07-26) — most recent upload [V]
- Now interviewing global tech leaders: Demis Hassabis (2026-02-19), Nothing CEO (2026-03-21), Meta AI Chief (2026-02-26) [V]

7. Landmines

Topic	Handling
Scenes' failure to monetise	he discusses it openly himself — usable, but frame as decision-making, not failure
Employee count vs. AI-leverage message	the core question, but ask it with genuine curiosity; framed as a gotcha it closes the conversation
Bangalore police work	commercial//government client — let him set the boundary
Auto-caption name errors	transcripts render him as "Arun Maya" in places. Verify every name and number against a primary source before the host says it aloud

8. Candidate angles — pick one before questions are written

A. "The 500-Person AI Company" ★ *recommended* The man teaching AI leverage runs 500 people and a 40-person game studio. What did AI actually replace, what did it not, and where does headcount still win? Unique to him, almost no supply, and directly useful to every founder watching.

B. "Why the AI guy is building a video game" A Souls-like from India, viral in China, a custom C++ engine, a 2008 teenage ambition finally attempted. The freshest material, strong visuals, but narrower in usefulness.

C. "What he wants to be remembered for" Built on the EOS legacy line. The most personal and least covered, but riskiest — it depends entirely on him being willing to go there.

Honest self-assessment

Research score: 7/10.

Strong: 129k words across 10 appearances covering 2023–2026, a recent delta that runs to last week, and a central tension backed by three direct quotes rather than a hunch.

Missing: 1. **Instagram: zero**, blocked on two actors. Web-search fallback not run. 2. **X/Twitter and comments not attempted** — deliberate, but they remain unknowns rather than confirmed dead ends for this guest specifically. 3. **Stage 2B topic research not started**, so the content-supply gap is argued from his own catalogue rather than the market's. 4. **The 500-employee figure is his own claim**, repeated twice by him and verified nowhere independently. Tagged [V] as "he said it", **not** as "it is true" — the host should attribute it out loud, not assert it. 5. **51 of 61 relevant videos untranscribed** — free, so pure upside.

To reach 9/10: independent verification of headcount and the billion-views claim, Stage 2B, and the Instagram fallback. Cost: near zero — the remaining work is mostly free.